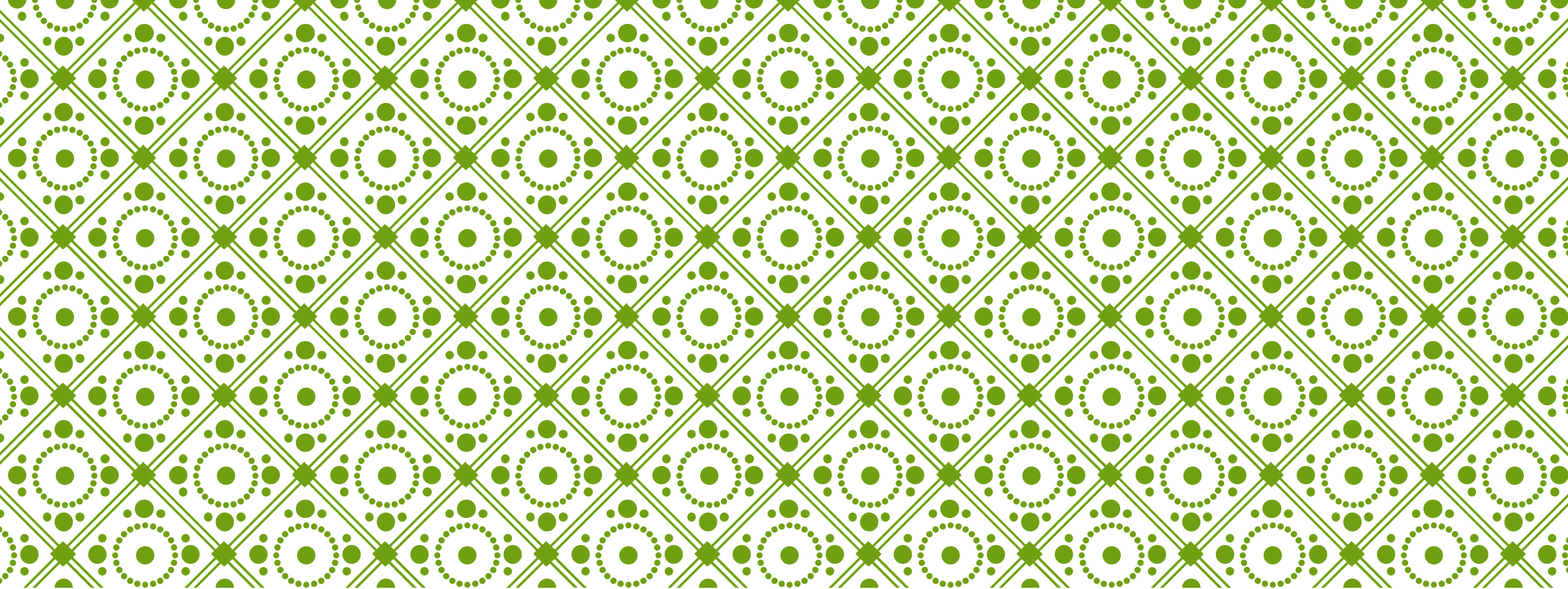




CONCEPT OF SARA AND OJAS IN AYURVEDA(UNIT -II)

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Introduction

- ❑ The Sara (essence of Dhatus) is considered to be an important concept of Ayurveda, which is responsible for assessing Bala (strength) and Sthiramsha (stability).
- ❑ Sara is a good mirror to assess properties and function of Dhatus (fundamental properties of the body).
- ❑ The inherent power of a person cannot be assessed by bulk and size of the body but it is only judges by the Sara examination.
- ❑ Our body is made up of 7 tissues. They are – lymph/plasma, blood , muscles, fat, bones, bone marrow & semen. These tissues not only form the anatomical make of our body but also would provide the first and best line of defence. The healthier the tissues, the healthier are our body & mind. The health, structural, and functional balance of our tissues also determines our immunity, fitness, endurance .
- ❑ Sara = essence / richness / strength
- ❑ Pariksha = examination.
- ❑ Examination of the essence and quality of tissues is very important in the clinical examination of the patient.

Types of Sara



what is Dhatu Sarata

- ❑ **Dhatu Sarata** means examination of body tissue quality.

What is the importance of Sarata examination

- ❑ To understand the strength of each Dhatu or tissues.
- ❑ Strength can not be understood everytime by just looking outer body frame of the person.

Types of Dhatu Sarata

1. **Uttam Sarata** = best quality tissue
 2. **Madhyam Sarata** = moderate quality tissue
 3. **Heena Sarata** = poor quality tissue
- ❑ If in the patient, heena or madyam sara dhatus are found, Vaidya (doctor or traditional physician) must advice Tonics or Rasayan Kalpas to improve the quality of tissue – so immunity will increase. Then there will be less chance of illness.
 - ❑ Rasayan or Tonics : improve Sarata from Heena or Madhyam sarata to Uttam Sarata or from poor quality to best quality.

Advice to Madhyam or Heena Sarata

- ☐ Drink enough water or cooling beverages like fruit juices, sugarcane juices.
- ☐ ORS
- ☐ Lemon juice
- ☐ Avoid fasting
- ☐ Avoid working in hot atmosphere like in hot summer out door activities
- ☐ Take care of liver . Eat food stuff having enough iron, copper, Vitamin B12 & Vitamin C
- ☐ Adequate muscle development exercises like weight lifting
- ☐ Adequate physical rest & sleep
- ☐ Balanced diet
- ☐ Avoid tobacco, alcohol

OJAS

- ❑ Ayurveda defines Ojas as “vigour”.
- ❑ It is the **vital energy** or core essence that nourishes all tissues and is responsible for the optimal functioning of our body, mind & spirit.
- ❑ Ojas is the vital energy that influences the body’s immune system.
- ❑ Weak Ojas affects your immunity and keeps you in low spirits.

Signs of weak Ojas become evident over time, some of which include :

- ❑ Dull and dry skin
- ❑ Pale complexion
- ❑ Low energy levels
- ❑ Poor mental and emotional clarity
- ❑ Musculoskeletal pain especially in the calves & back that support your body weight.
- ❑ Inability to focus.

How to increase Ojas

- ❑ Exercise every day.
- ❑ By doing exercises it will keep your digestive fire and metabolism in proper working order.
- ❑ According to Ayurveda, here are some of the best Ojas increasing foods you can incorporate into your diet such as : bananas, almonds, avocado, sweet potato, dates, tofu.
- ❑ Foods that must avoid in order to preserve your diet : alcohol, refined flour, deep-fried foods, undercooked foods.
- ❑ Aswagandhadi Lehyam : an all-natural supplement by Kerala Ayurveda. It is fortified with Ashwaganga or winter cherry and other vital herbs like shunthi or ginger , masha or black gram or sesame that help restore strength & vigour.
- ❑ Among other ingredients , Aswagandhadi Lehyam contains honey for better taste and bioavailability. This means your body will readily absorb and benefit from this herbal formulation.
- ❑ Recommended dosage : 10 to 20 grams, twice a day.
- ❑ Chyawanprash : rich source in vitamin C and other vital nutrients that help improve strength, immunity and longevity. Also helps in digestion.
- ❑ Amrutharishtam : herbal Ojas that gives you strength to fight infections and clears post infective symptoms like reduced appetite.
- ❑ In addition to taking supplements and eating healthy food , you can build Ojas externally through self-abhyanga. It is recommended to use warm medicated oil for the massage

IF HEALTH IS WEALTH, THEN OJAS IS GOLD

LOOKING AT THE WORLD THROUGH THE LENSES OF DRAVYA, GUNA AND KARMA

- ❑ In ayurveda , the concepts of dravya (substance), guna(qualities), and karma (action) are fundamental in understanding how the universe & life operates.
- ❑ Dravya : it refers to any material that has the potential to bring about a particular effect. Dravya can be anything **tangible, herbs, food, minerals** as well as intangible such as time, thoughts and emotions.
- ❑ Guna : it refers to the qualities that a dravya possesses. Such as **hot & cold, heavy or light; dry or moist;** example : ginger has heating properties (ushna guna), while cucumber is cooling (shita guna).
- ❑ Karma : it denotes the action that a particular dravya with specific guna will have on on the body and mind. Example : ginger (heating) has a digestive action (karma) that can alleviate coldness in the digestive system and thus it aids digestion.
- ❑ The three concepts : **the dravya (substances) contains specific gunas (quantities) that give rise to its karma (action).**
- ❑ This helps in understanding how the substances interact with the body's constitution imbalances and the environment to promote healing & maintain health.

APPLYING THE PRINCIPLE OF SAMANYA AND VISESHA IN EVERY ASPECT OF LIFE TO ACHIEVE PERFECT HEALTH

- ❑ **Samanya means (similarity) and Vishesha means (dissimilarity)** are the fundamental concepts in ayurveda that is important in achieving and maintaining good and perfect health.
- ❑ **Principles of samanya** : this principle suggests that substances or qualities that are similar in nature to the body's existing state will increase those qualities. Example : if someone is experiencing a cold , consuming cold , icecreams or cucumbers would aggravate this condition because it is 'like increases like'.
- ❑ **Principle of vishesha** : this principle states that the use of dissimilar or opposite qualities can help reduce excess or imbalance in the body or mind. Example : if there is excess heat in the body, cooling substances like cucumber or coconut water are used to balance the heat.
- ❑ By understanding the concept of samanya and vishesha in every aspects of life , the ultimate goal in ayurveda is to maintain the homeostasis. By continuously assessing according to these principles, one can achieve a state of perfect health where the body , mind and spirit are in harmony.

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